Mecha-Lions

FTC #21781

Stratford Preparatory Blackford Robotics

TEAM INTRODUCTION

#10252

Team #10252 Mecha-Lions is the flagship team of Stratford Preparatory Blackford, comprised of 15 high schoolers passionate about robotics, working hours to reach our goal. During this year's **REBUILT** season, we hope not only to build a winning robot, but also to build strong relationships with each other and our community. Robotics welcomes anyone of any interest.

LIBRARY WORKSHOP

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- In October, our business team hosted a robotics workshop at the Santa Clara City Library through the Teens Teach program.
- The workshop introduced elementary and middle school students to robotics using LEGO EV3 kits.
- Students learned both building and programming skills during the event.
- The activity encouraged creativity, teamwork, and problem-solving as students tested and improved their designs.
- This outreach allowed us to share STEM education with younger students while also improving our leadership and communication skills.

CREATION OF FLL TEAMS

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- We created and mentored two FIRST LEGO League teams virtually based at Westlake Middle School.
- Throughout the season, we supported students with guidance and resources.
  Two members of our business team led weekly meetings focused on project development, presentation skills, and competition preparation.
- Consistent mentorship helped students build confidence and improve teamwork.
- The experience gave students a strong foundation in robotics, innovation, and collaboration.

MIDDLE SCHOOL MENTORSHIP

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- We mentored three rookie FIRST LEGO League (FLL) teams, assigning mentors to each meeting and providing guidance, advice, and part sourcing support.
- One of the teams reached the regional level, marking a major milestone in their first season.
- Our robotics team presented our robot at local middle schools, including Pasitos Middle School.
- During these presentations, we showcased our robot and shared the skills we developed throughout the season.
- These outreach efforts helped inspire younger students to explore robotics and pursue their interests in STEM.

GRANTS

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- Throughout the season, our team applied for multiple grants through HCB Hack Club to support our robotics program and secure necessary resources.
- We researched organizations that fund STEM education, sustainability initiatives, and youth robotics.
- Each grant application was tailored to align with the goals and values of the organization providing the funding.
- In the applications, we emphasized our team's mission, outreach efforts, community involvement, and long-term growth plans.

ARGOSY FOUNDATION

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- We received a $3,000 Rookie Grant from the Argosy Foundation as we started our FRC team.
- The funding supported the purchase of essential tools, robot components, and materials for our first season.
- This grant helped us establish a strong foundation and confidently begin our journey in FIRST Robotics.

HITACHI AMERICAS

#10252

HITACHI
Inspire the Next

- As a result of our grant outreach, we received 12 computers from Hitachi valued at over $6,000.
- We distributed these computers to our FLL teams in Oakland to support robotics and coding.
- The donation helped reduce barriers to participation for students and expanded access to STEM education.
- This initiative strengthened our mission to make STEM opportunities more accessible and impactful.

INTUITIVE

#10252

- As a result of our grant outreach efforts, we received a $500 grant from Intuitive.
- The funding supported essential build-season and competition expenses.
- This grant helped reduce financial strain, allowing our team to focus more on building our robot rather than budget concerns.

SPBROBOTICS WEBSITE

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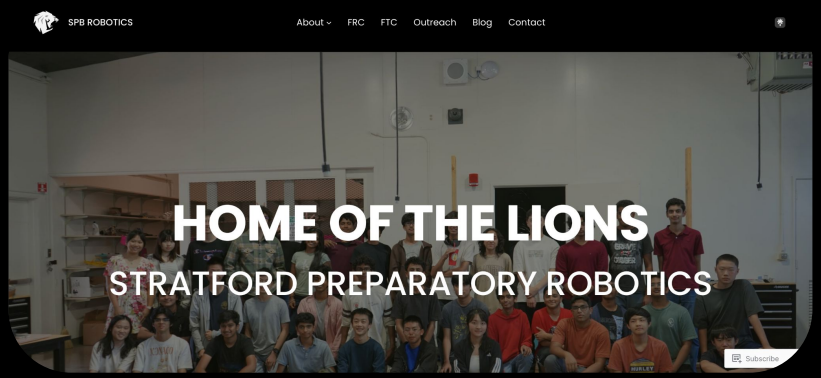
- Our business team developed the official SPB Robotics website to increase accessibility for students, families, and community partners.
- The website serves as a central hub for resources, event updates, and team documentation.
- It allows anyone to engage with robotics, regardless of prior experience.
- Our goal with the website is to inspire future innovators and support growth in other robotics teams.



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FINAL STATEMENT

Our goal as a team is to inspire, impact, and influence our community, and to promote success both within and outside of our team. We hope to make a positive impact on the world, and help pave the way to a better future with the skills we've learned and connections we've made in robotics.

SOCIAL MEDIA

@frc10252